28 Oct 2026 08:05:24 ET | 10 pages

Eli Lilly (LLY.N)

Retatrutide delivers clear superiority over Novo's Ozempic in type 2 diabetes head-to-head study

CITI'S TAKE

The phase 3 TRANSCEND-T2D-2 head-to-head study further reinforces retatrutide's (triple-G agonist) class-leading efficacy and manageable safety profile, delivering greater HbA1c reduction and more than double the weight loss of Novo's (covered by Graham Parry) Ozempic (semaglutide) 2mg in the tougher-to-treat type 2 diabetes (T2D) population. Indeed, retatrutide 9mg/12mg achieved 19.5%/20.9% weight loss vs. 9.4% for Ozempic, alongside 2.2% HbA1c reductions vs. 1.8%. The 12mg dose achieved multiplicity-controlled superiority on both endpoints, while 9mg was superior on weight loss and nominally significant on HbA1c after meeting noninferiority. Tolerability remained consistent with the incretin class, although adverse-event increased with dose. Overall, the data reaffirm retatrutide's differentiated efficacy across weight and glycemic control, strengthening its position as a key long-term cardiometabolic growth driver (BBG cons 2032e: $11.2B) ahead of the planned 1Q27 FDA submission and the more important head-to-head comparison (TRIUMPH-5; data 4Q26e) with its tirzepatide. Maintain Buy and $1,600 TP.

Buy	
Price (27 Oct 26 16:00)	US$1,281.91
Target price	US$1,600.00
Expected share price return	24.8%
Expected dividend yield	0.5%
Expected total return	25.4%
Market Cap	US$1,206,735M

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

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Eli Lilly

Valuation

We set our DCF derived valuation at $1,600. We project free cash flows for an explicit forecast period to 2035 and thereafter apply terminal growth assumptions. We employ a CAPM-derived WACC of 6% and assume a 2.6% terminal growth rate.

Risks

Key downside risks include: 1) validated or ficticious adverse events associated with Mounjaro/Zepbound impacting adoption; 2) proposed US rebate reform being passed through congress which would reduce barriers to entry for competition; 3) tirzepatide portfolio facing formulary step-edits through generic semaglutide from 2032E.

Key upside risks include: 1) adoption of Alzheimer's drug donanemab above our modest expectations; 2) positive evolution of pipeline including remternetug, orforglipron, retatrutide, and more; and 3) lower than expected impact of IRA price negotiation on Verzenio and Trulicity.

If the impact on the company from any of these factors proves to be greater/less than we anticipate, the stock could materially undershoot or overshoot our target price.

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Eli Lilly (LLY)

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Fundamental Research

Analyst: Geoff Meacham, Ph.D.



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	02-Apr-24 00:00:00	1	*895.00	763.96
2	08-Jul-24 07:25:51	*--	-	918.00
3	13-Sep-24 00:00:00	*1	*1,060.00	923.71
4	25-Oct-24 01:48:44	1	*1,250.00	892.70
5	28-Jan-25 05:00:00	1	*1,190.00	804.99
6	06-Nov-25 17:11:40	1	*1,250.00	937.44
7	12-Nov-25 05:00:00	1	*1,500.00	1,017.78
8	15-Jul-26 05:00:00	1	*1,600.00	1,156.63

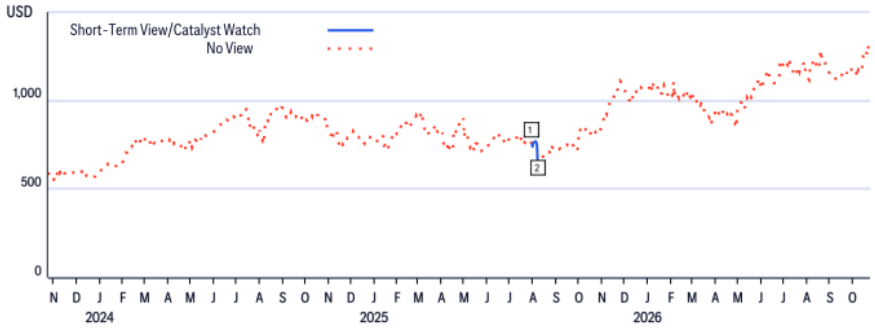
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Eli Lilly (LLY)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Geoff Meacham, Ph.D.



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	30-Jul-25 01:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	760.08
2	08-Aug-25 16:08:22	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	625.65

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
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